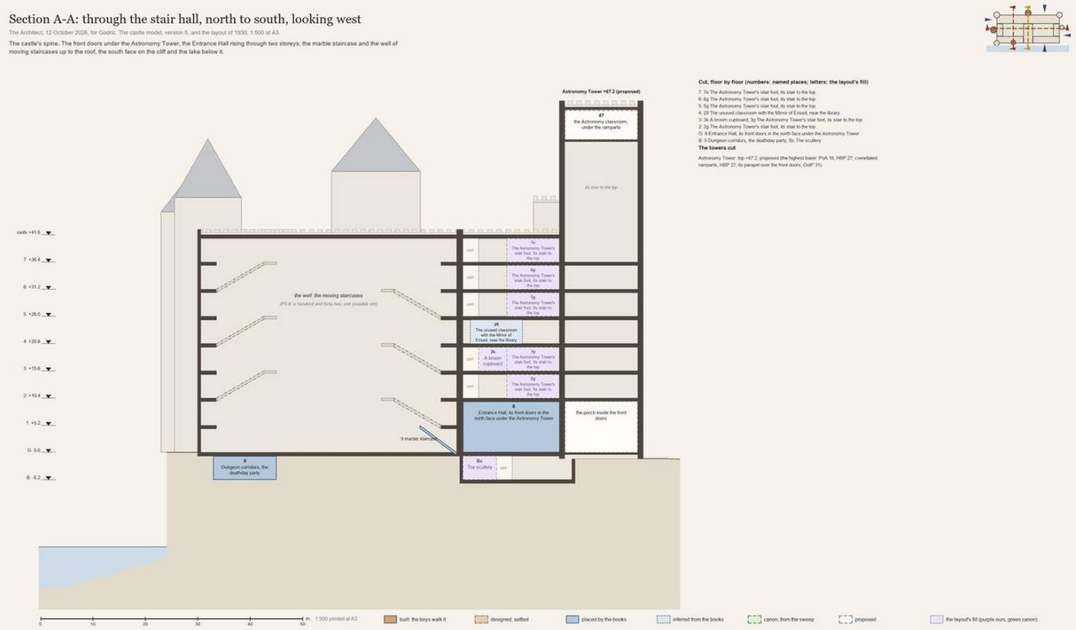
Question 7: the founders' keep inside

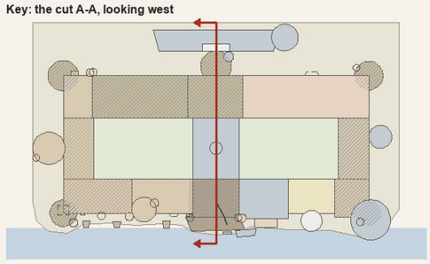
The Architect, 12 to 13 October 2026, for Godric. Drawn under 6.1 (the founders' keep), pending Godric's answer to Question 6; a 6.2 or 6.3 morning is a redraw. From the same pieces as the faces (architect-accreted-2308). Model version 5; ours unless a book line is named.

Canon, checked at the gate: "a hundred and forty-two staircases at Hogwarts" (PS 8); the boats' tunnel "right underneath the castle" to "a kind of underground harbor", then "a passageway in the rock" up to the grass (PS 6). The keep, its walls and the great window are ours.

Now: Section A-A as drawn at 8.36 pm (architect-sections-2036, from the model's masses)



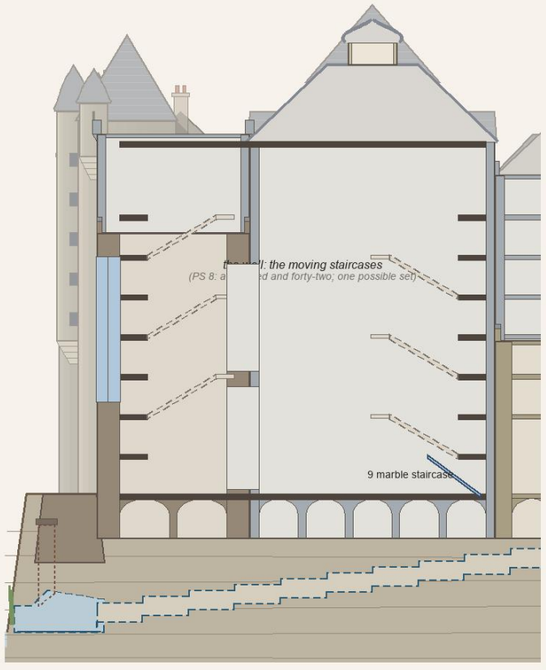
Under 6.1, A-A through the keep and the well, 1:800, the three ways



Why 7.1: the keep was a refuge; once the castle had walls and a gate, its dark floors were worth less than light for the stairs. The boys climbing the moving staircases see the oldest stone from inside, the holes where the founders' beams once sat: a find-the-oldest-stone clue. 7.2 shrinks the model's well; 7.3 keeps rooms but makes the well dark.

- the founders, about 990
- the high towers, 1400 to 1500
- the last additions, 1800 to 1900
- the first walls, 1100 to 1200
- Tudor, 1500 to 1600
- the towers of the houses, 1250 to 1350
- the turret builders, 1600 to 1750

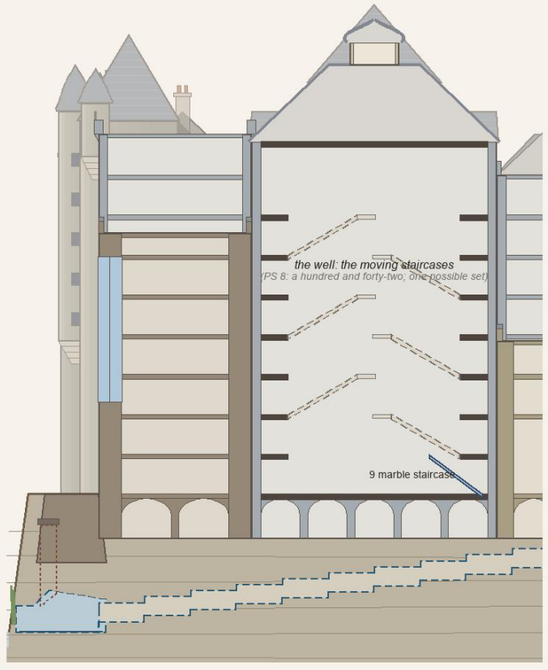
7.1 The keep hollowed for the well



When the ward was roofed (1400s), the founders' floors came out: the moving staircases climb inside the founders' walls, the great window lights them from the lake, and the joist pockets of the lost floors still show. The model's well (0 to 50 m) holds. Rule 8: wrapped, not removed.

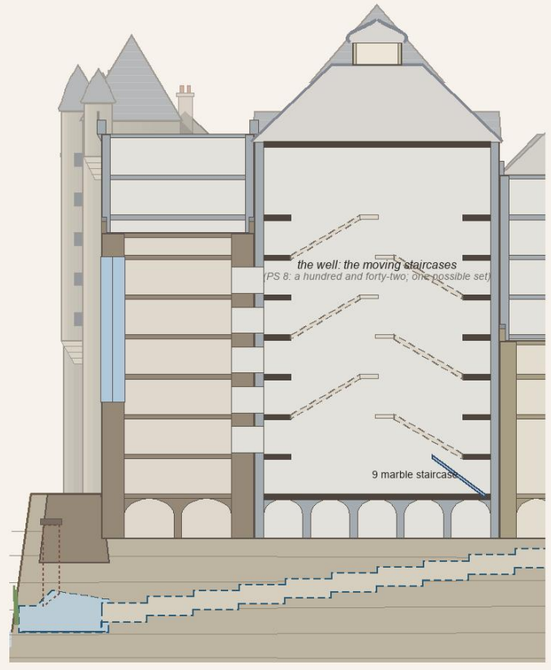
recommended

7.2 The keep keeps its four floors



The founders' rooms stay, one above another; the well stops at the keep's north wall, 32 m long, not 50; the great window lights a room, not the stairs. The model's stair hall shrinks by 18 m.

7.3 Floors kept, opened onto the well

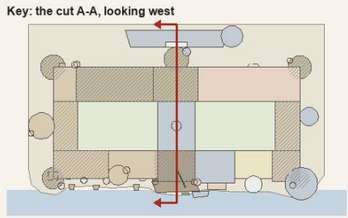


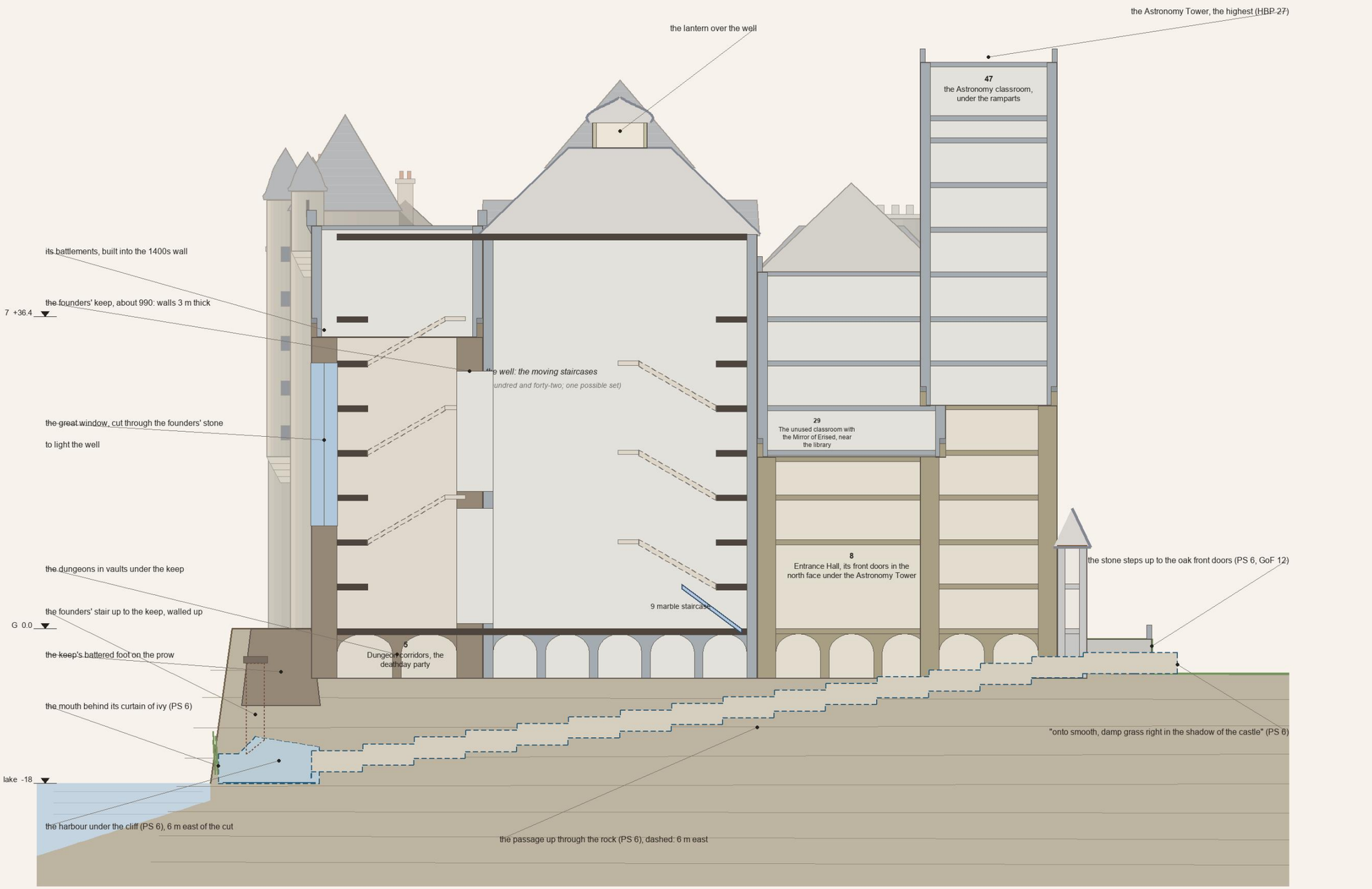
The founders' rooms stay as galleries, their north wall opened in arches on every floor; the well borrows the great window's light through them. The model's well holds; the keep's rooms become landings.

Section A-A: through the stair hall and the keep on its prow, looking west

The Architect, 12 to 13 October 2026, for Godric. Drawn under 6.1 (the founders' keep), pending Godric's answer to Question 6; a 6.2 or 6.3 morning is a redraw. From the same pieces as the faces (architect-accreted-2308). Model version 5; ours unless a book line is named.

The castle's spine, north to south, looking west, the 2036 sheet's cut. The keep on its prow over the harbour, its walls 3 m thick and its battlements still inside the 1400s wall; the well of moving staircases (PS 8) inside the keep and the founders' roofed ward (7.1, recommended); the Entrance Hall through two storeys; the Astronomy Tower over the front doors. The boats' way in, from 6 m east of the cut, dashed: through the ivy, the tunnel, the harbour under the cliff, then the passage up through the rock to the grass by the front steps (PS 6; the model's harbour, Godric's 4.1).



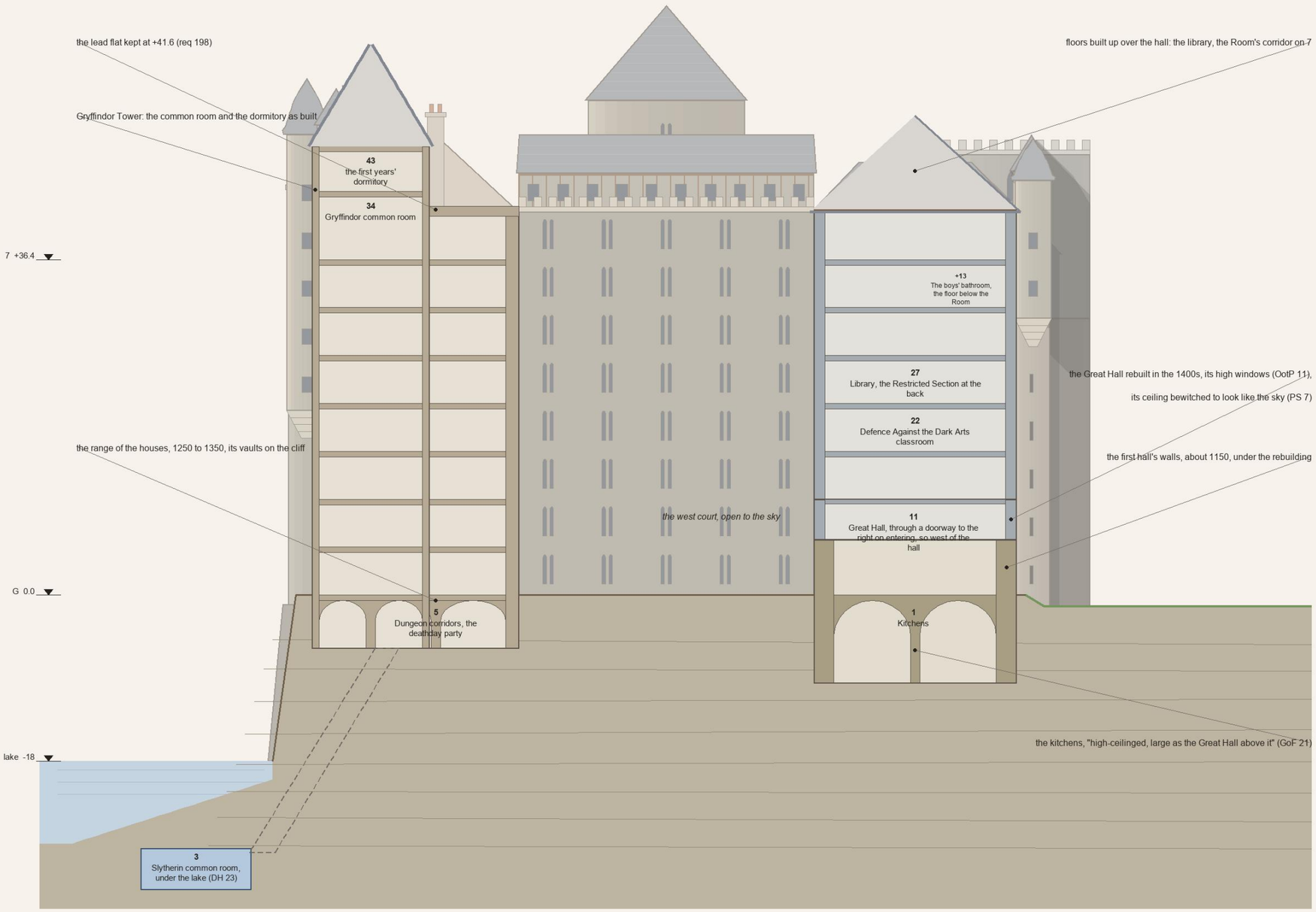


Cut walls in their age's colour, thicker the older; what stands beyond the cut drawn paler; the boats' way dashed; rooms named from the 2036 sheet.

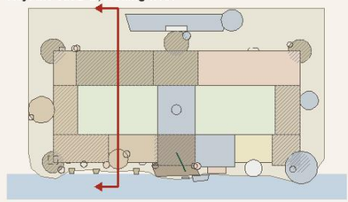
Section B-B: through Gryffindor Tower and the Great Hall, looking west

The Architect, 12 to 13 October 2026, for Godric. Drawn under 6.1 (the founders' keep), pending Godric's answer to Question 6; a 6.2 or 6.3 morning is a redraw. From the same pieces as the faces (architect-accreted-2308). Model version 5; ours unless a book line is named.

Where the boys live. Gryffindor Tower as built (the common room on 7, the dormitory above it), the lead flat east of it at +41.6, the range of the houses on vaults over the cliff, the west court, and the Great Hall: the first walls' hall raised in the 1400s, the high windows (OotP 11), the kitchens under it as large as the hall (GoF 21); Slytherin's room deep under the lake (DH 23).



Key: the cut B-B, looking west



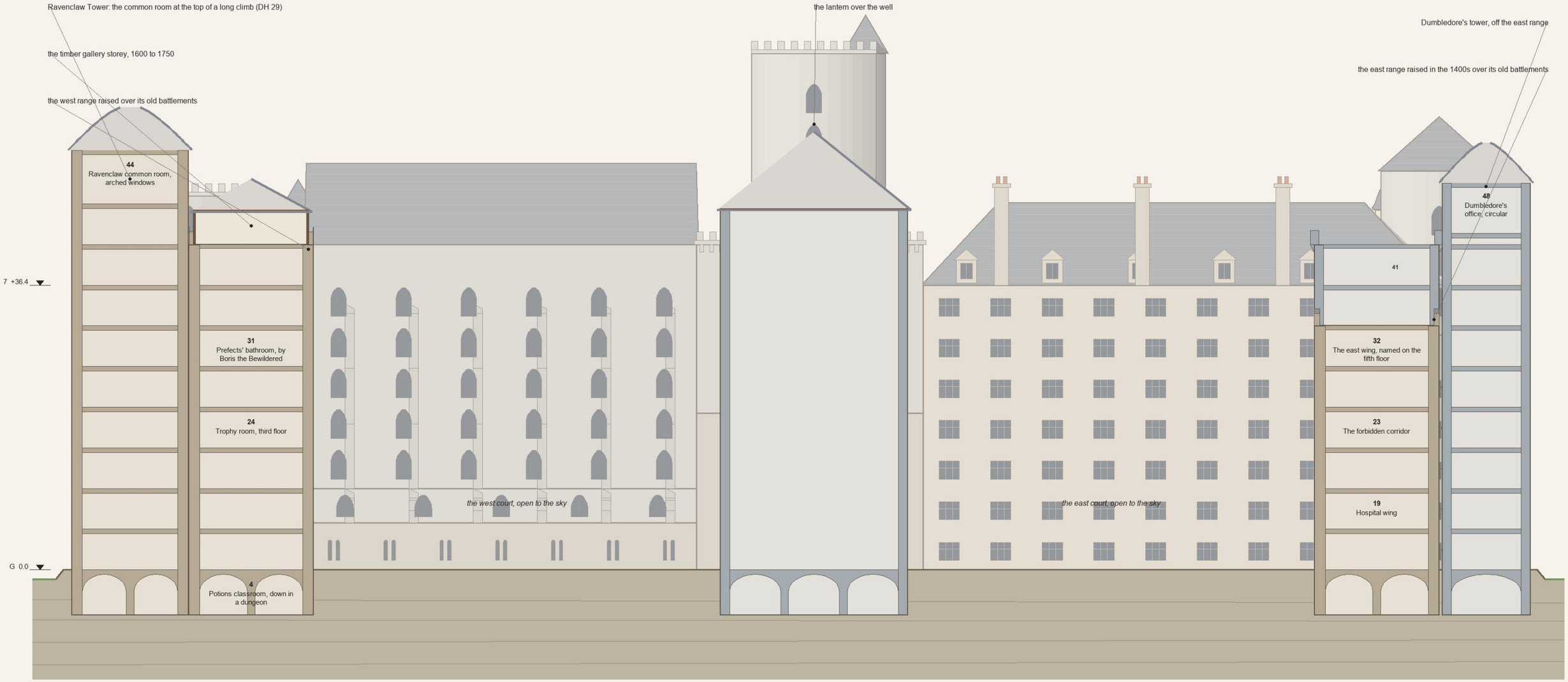
the founders, about 990
Tudor, 1500 to 1600
the first walls, 1100 to 1200
the turret builders, 1600 to 1750
the towers of the houses, 1250 to 1350
the last additions, 1800 to 1900
the high towers, 1400 to 1500

Cut walls in their age's colour, thicker the older; what stands beyond the cut drawn paler; the boats' way dashed; rooms named from the 2036 sheet.

Section C-C: across the two courts, looking north

The Architect, 12 to 13 October 2026, for Godric. Drawn under 6.1 (the founders' keep), pending Godric's answer to Question 6; a 6.2 or 6.3 morning is a redraw. From the same pieces as the faces (architect-accreted-2308). Model version 5; ours unless a book line is named.

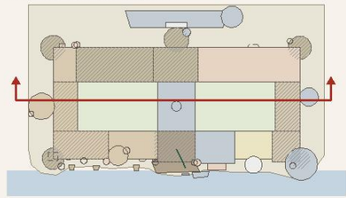
The castle's width, west to east, looking north. Ravenclaw Tower and the west range with its timber gallery storey, the two courts open to the sky with each side a different century (the north side beyond: the Great Hall, the gate range, the Tudor lodgings), the stair hall's well under its lantern, the east range raised over its old battlements, and Dumbledore's tower.



the founders, about 990
Tudor, 1500 to 1600
the first walls, 1100 to 1200
the turret builders, 1600 to 1750
the towers of the houses, 1250 to 1350
the last additions, 1800 to 1900
the high towers, 1400 to 1500

Cut walls in their age's colour, thicker the older; what stands beyond the cut drawn paler; the boats' way dashed; rooms named from the 2036 sheet.

Key: the cut C-C, looking north



What made each piece: Godric's five engines

The Architect, 12 to 13 October 2026, for Godric. Drawn under 6.1 (the founders' keep), pending Godric's answer to Question 6; a 6.2 or 6.3 morning is a redraw. From the same pieces as the faces (architect-accreted-2308). Model version 5; ours unless a book line is named.

Variation, accretion, restoration, expansion, and evolving tastes and purpose (Godric, 10.28 pm). One line per piece, age by age, the same list every face, plan and section is drawn from.

variation (10) **accretion (20)** **restoration (6)** **expansion (23)** **tastes and purpose (12)**

keep-foot	accretion: the founders battered the keep down the prow to the rock, over the harbour
keep	tastes and purpose: a refuge far from Muggle eyes (CoS 9): slits, one door, reached by water
sw-drum	expansion: the school outgrew the keep; the heirs walled the plateau, a drum at each corner
se-drum	expansion: the curtain's south-east corner on the cliff
west-tower	expansion: the curtain's north-west corner on the land side
north-tower	expansion: the curtain's north-east corner on the land side
gate-tower	tastes and purpose: the one way in by land, guarded: the Astronomy Tower's root
hall-low	tastes and purpose: a school wants one room to eat and meet in: the first Great Hall
gate	expansion: the passage through the north curtain, the Entrance Hall's place
spur-1	accretion: masonry propping the curtain where it overhangs the cliff
spur-2	accretion: a second spur where the bay of cliff falls back
spur-3	accretion: a third, under the range by Gryffindor Tower
srw-low	expansion: the houses wanted lodgings: a range built inside the curtain
srw-east	expansion: the range by Gryffindor Tower, its lead flat kept to this day
west-range	expansion: the west range, closing the west court's side
east-range	expansion: the east range, closing the east court's side
nr-west	expansion: lodgings against the north curtain beside the hall
se-block	expansion: the south-east lodging stepping down the ledges
gryffindor	tastes and purpose: a house that climbs: the dormitory at the top (GoF 12)
ravenclaw	tastes and purpose: a house that climbs: the long stair, arched windows (DH 29)
garderobe	accretion: a privy corbelled out over the cliff, of its age
garderobe-n	accretion: a privy tower on the north curtain
keep-raise	accretion: the founders' battlements built into a taller wall in a time of fear
sw-raise	accretion: the drum raised over its old battlements
se-raise	accretion: the drum raised, later swallowed by the gun platform
se-battery	tastes and purpose: cannon came: a squat gun platform wrapped round the old drum
west-raise	accretion: raised for watch; its top later the Owlery (GoF 15)
north-raise	accretion: raised for watch; Divination at the top later (PoA 6)
astronomy	accretion: the gate tower raised to the highest of all (HBP 27), a watchtower first
astro-stair	accretion: a stair turret to the new top, its own cap
hall-high	restoration: the Great Hall rebuilt higher, its high windows (OotP 11), its ceiling bewitched (PS 7)
hall-upper	expansion: floors of rooms built up over the rebuilt hall: the library, the Room's corridor on 7
gate-raise	accretion: the gate range raised to the walls' new height
stair-hall	tastes and purpose: the founders' ward roofed over; its stairs learnt to move (PS 8)
hall-range	expansion: a new range on the south-east cliff, standing on vaults where the rock steps down
east-raise	accretion: the east range raised with the rest
se-block-raise	accretion: the south-east lodging raised with the rest
dumbledore	expansion: a tower off the east range, the head's
water-battery	tastes and purpose: the harbour is a way in: a small battery at the cliff's foot
terrace	tastes and purpose: the gun terrace over the filled ditch; the front steps climb its old face (PS 6)
north-battery	tastes and purpose: a low, fat battery on the land approach
breteche	accretion: a box over the harbour mouth to drop things on boats
srw-tudor	restoration: the fire of the 1540s: the range's upper floors rebuilt in warmer stone
oriel	variation: a room wanted light and a seat over the lake
bay	variation: the widest windows on the face, the Tudor rose in its gable
chimney-breast	tastes and purpose: fires in every room: comfort
gry-cone	variation: the tower's battlements traded for a slate cone
rav-cone	variation: the same taste on Ravenclaw's tower
north-cone	variation: a cone on the North Tower
dumb-cone	variation: a cone on the head's tower
sw-caphouse	variation: a cap house on the drum's top, a warm room
nr-east	expansion: Tudor lodgings along the north curtain, mullioned
gry-stair	accretion: a stair turret in the angle, so no old wall was cut
keep-stair	accretion: a stair turret where the keep meets the hall range
hall-stair	accretion: a stair turret at the Great Hall's west end
nr-oriel	variation: an oriel on the north lodgings
link	restoration: the link rebuilt two storeys lower; the date stone 1647
keep-bart-w	expansion: floor out of nothing: a bartizan on the keep's corner
keep-bart-e	expansion: its pair on the other corner
sw-turret	expansion: a stair turret clinging to the drum from 20 m up
se-turret	expansion: a turret on the gun platform's drum
tudor-oriel	variation: a round oriel on the Tudor range, a bell cap
study	expansion: Clementine's study (Q33): floor where there was no ground
gallery	variation: a lighter timber storey on the west range
lantern	tastes and purpose: light for the well of moving stairs, an ogee cap
rav-bart	expansion: a bartizan on Ravenclaw Tower
north-bart	expansion: a bartizan on the North Tower
nr-turret	expansion: a turret by the Great Hall's west end
lake-tower	restoration: a restorer's Middle Ages: machicolations that never held a stone
porch	restoration: a porch over the oak front doors, older in manner than its age
lake-cone	restoration: the lake tower's cone, crisp and regular